splattered on her clothes and over her hands.

Katya wailed, legs kicking.

Léa saw the baby's curly hair sticky with blood. Hadn't Katya lost everything, too? A father on the battlefield, a mother giving birth, all the grandparents, aunts and uncles she would never know. And yet *she* had the will to go on. Life was all questions with no answers, chance moments that decided one's fate.

Léa had the sense that Katya was urging her to get up and move. But she had no strength and turned away, tears streaming down her face. She wasn't sure she could do this. And then Josef's words from last night came to her. *We can make the world what we want it to be.* Isn't that what she'd tried to do but failed? Was she meant to keep trying, not give up? If she'd survived, maybe she owed it to those who hadn't—Nadiya, Ewa, André, Josef—to keep going.

Katya howled, inconsolable.

There was something sad and lonely in these woods. The light didn't enter and a chill clung to the air. She could feel the dampness in her bones, and she knew she didn't belong here. She had wanted somewhere to hide, to get away from the man with the Karabiner—but now it was time to go. She wanted to step out of this dark, lonely place and into the light.

Katya bellowed, gulping for air.

"I'm coming," Léa said. She stood and wiped the tears from her face. She brushed off the leaves and twigs on her clothes and pulled her hair back and away from her face. She opened the bag and removed one of the bottles—there were only two.

Katya was hungry. Léa was grateful for something so simple. She could go through the motions of feeding a child, and that would propel her forward. And after she fed her, she'd bring her to the stream—she'd thought she'd heard water rustling nearby—and clean and wash as much of the blood away as she could.

Léa went to her. Katya's eyes were tightly closed, limbs flailing, face red, mouth trembling. Léa watched her for a moment, then lifted her. The baby went still, opened her eyes and listened.

"Yes, I'm here," Léa whispered. "I know you're hungry. I'm sorry, I just needed a bit of time on my own. I'm here. Come, feed."

Sucking on the bottle, Katya's deep, dark eyes watched Léa as if she